

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN JERSEY

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the coast and countryside of Jersey, and the long fight over Plémont shows how a community can save a treasured place even after the developers have won planning permission to build. When the derelict Plémont holiday camp on the island's north-west coast — eleven and a half acres of coastal headland beside the last puffin colony in Jersey — was slated for housing, and consent for twenty-eight homes was finally granted in 2012, islanders did not accept the loss of one of the island's finest stretches of coast. Led by the National Trust for Jersey, they had already campaigned for over a decade; now they pressed on, through the States Assembly and the public, until a different path opened. The Trust agreed to buy the site; the States voted to fund half the purchase; the Trust raised the rest; and the headland was bought, the buildings demolished, and the land returned to nature. And so, after fourteen years of campaigning, a place cleared for houses became an open, wild headland for everyone. a place cleared for houses became, instead, an open and wild headland for everyone, forever.

The Plémont story teaches two things about stopping destructive projects here — including its honest limits, which this guide states plainly and up front. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever — the community, the evidence, the coalition, and the pressure on the deciders — pressed together. The second is distinctly Jersey, and it is what makes this guide different from many others. **A community here can save a treasured place even after losing the planning battle — by buying the site out, through a conservation trust, public funding, and fundraising, and returning it to nature.** That combination — the coalition, the sustained campaign, the political route through the Assembly, and above all the buyout-and-restoration — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it.

But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide places first and takes seriously. The Plémont win was real, but it came in a particular and instructive way. **The planning fight was lost:** after years of applications and a public inquiry, consent for twenty-eight homes was granted. The community won not by defeating the development on planning grounds but by **buying the land** — a route that required raising over eight million pounds, roughly half of it public money voted by the States, which was genuinely contentious. And it took **fourteen years**. This guide does not pretend the win was quick, cheap, or won on the planning merits. What it shows is how a community, having lost the planning battle, still saved a treasured headland by acquiring and rewilding it — and how those levers can be used again.

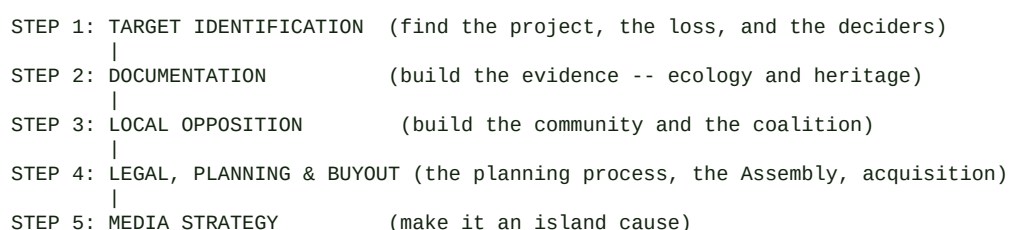
Most communities do not know HOW to make their power effective, especially once permission is granted. They hear that consent has been given and assume "the development is approved and nothing can be done," and never build the coalition, never work the Assembly, never pursue a buyout. They generate private regret without organised opposition. The gap between places saved and places built is rarely apathy — Plémont proved a community will campaign for fourteen years. It is method: knowing how to build the coalition, work the political route, and pursue the buyout and restoration that can save a place even after planning is lost.

This guide shows what actually works — inside the Jersey system as it is, and grounded in a fight the community, in the end, won. It is written for the person who has heard that a treasured coastline, field,

or green space is to be developed — perhaps even with permission already granted — and who wants to know whether anything can still be done. The answer is yes, with the honest qualifier that a Jersey win may come through a costly buyout rather than a planning victory, and may take many years — and that the way to it runs through the coalition, the Assembly, and the acquisition and rewilding of the land. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used. It is for the person willing to work through coalitions, the planning process, the Assembly, fundraising, and, above all, patience — the methods that saved Plémont over fourteen years. That is not a lesser form of action but, in a small and civil island, the most effective one, because it builds the credibility, the breadth, and the endurance that a Jersey save requires. The guide is honest that this took a decade and more, that the planning fight was lost, and that the win came by a costly purchase. But it is equally honest that the headland stands wild and open to all, and that is a real and repeatable achievement. the headland stands wild and open to all, its buildings gone and its coast restored, and that is a real and repeatable achievement. Read it not as a promise of a quick planning victory but as a map of how a small, determined island saved a treasured place by buying it back, even after the developers had won the right to build.

The Strategic Framework

Effective campaigns follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to save a coastal headland, a field, a green space, or another treasured place from development:



These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The ecological and heritage evidence feeds the coalition, the media, and the Assembly at once; the coalition grows; a fundraising drive or a political proposition is both pressure and a spur to the next. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, is the one that wins what can be won here — a place saved, whether by planning or, as at Plémont, by buyout and restoration. The National Trust for Jersey's campaign did exactly this, over fourteen years.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every jurisdiction's system has its own pressure points. Jersey's — a small, close-knit island with a strong National Trust, an accessible legislature, and a deep attachment to its coast — give communities a distinctive set:

- **The National Trust for Jersey.** A **respected conservation body that can acquire and hold land** is the distinctive lever, as it was the spine of the Plémont win.
- **The States Assembly.** An **accessible legislature that can vote public funds** for a purchase, as it did for Plémont, is a real political route.
- **The buyout.** A **conservation acquisition of a site, even one with planning consent**, can save it where planning cannot, as at Plémont.
- **The island's attachment to its coast.** A **small island's love of its scarce, treasured coast** mobilises powerfully, as it did over fourteen years.

- **Ecology and heritage.** Rare species, landscape, and archaeology make the case, as Plémont's puffins, lizards, and history did.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers guarantee a planning victory, or a cheap or quick one. Plémont's planning fight was **lost**; the win came through a **costly buyout** — over eight million pounds, half of it contentious public money — over **fourteen years**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them first and throughout — and shows how to use the real, distinctive tools this system offers — the Trust, the Assembly, the buyout, the island's attachment, and the ecology and heritage case — as they were used to save a headland even after the developers had won the right to build.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides your project's fate, at which level, and where along that path the project — or the leverage — is weakest. And map what would be lost and where the coalition, the planning process, the Assembly, and the possibility of a buyout apply, because in Jersey a treasured place is often best saved by building the coalition, making the case, working the Assembly, and — even after planning is granted — pursuing a conservation buyout and restoration, as Plémont was.

The Levels of Decision

A Jersey development runs through several tracks at once, and each is a place to intervene.

The planning system. The **planning authorities and the minister** grant or refuse consent; Plémont's consent for twenty-eight homes was granted here, which is why the fight had to move beyond planning.

The States Assembly. The **States Assembly** — an accessible legislature — can vote public funds and adopt propositions, as it did to fund the Plémont purchase; it is a distinctive political route to a save.

The National Trust for Jersey. The **Trust** can **acquire, hold, and restore land**, and was the body that bought and rewilded Plémont; a conservation buyer is the lever that saves a site planning could not.

The conservation and heritage bodies. **Ecology, landscape, and heritage considerations** weigh in decisions, as Plémont's rare species and history did.

The public and the coalition. The **island public, the Trust's members, and the environmental groups** are the levers that give a case its force, as they gave Plémont's over fourteen years.

The Journey of a Project

A typical development moves from an application, through planning consent, toward construction — with the **community's evidence, the coalition, the planning process, the Assembly, and the possibility of a buyout** able to intervene, even after consent, as Plémont showed. **Even a granted permission is not the end of the road**, because a conservation buyout can still save the site, as Plémont's was bought after consent. The distinctive levers are the **coalition**, the **planning process**, the **Assembly**, the **buyout**, and **restoration**. Find out exactly where the project stands, and, crucially, **what treasured place would be lost, whether a conservation buyout is possible, and how the Assembly and the Trust can act**, because those are often where a place can still be saved.

Follow the Project, the Place, and the Deciders

Behind a project stand a proponent — often a developer with planning consent — and the approvals or the sale that decide the site's fate. Trace who decides, who owns the land, and — importantly here — **what ecological and heritage value the place holds, whether the owner would sell to a conservation body, how the Assembly might fund a purchase, and whether the Trust can hold and restore it.** Two questions unlock most Jersey fights of this kind: **What would be lost, and can the site be bought and saved even if planning is granted?** and **Where — the coalition, the Assembly, the Trust, the public — can that save be secured?** The coalition and the buyout are, together, the heart of most such campaigns. It is worth naming why this pairing is so potent in Jersey specifically. The coalition supplies the credibility, the endurance, and the public feeling that a years-long campaign requires, while the buyout supplies the mechanism to save a place even after planning is lost. In many places a community with strong feeling still has no way to stop an approved development; in Jersey, strong feeling channelled through the Trust and the Assembly can buy the land itself. That is why a campaign here should invest early and heavily in both: the coalition that sustains the fight and moves the Assembly, and the buyout machinery — the Trust, the seller, the funding — that converts that feeling into a purchase. Neither alone saved Plémont; together, over fourteen years, they were decisive.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a decision, because they are levers too. The **planning authorities and the minister**; the **States Assembly**; the **National Trust for Jersey**; the **conservation and heritage bodies**; the **environmental groups and the Trust's membership**; the **local press**; and the **close-knit island public** for whom the coast is precious. In Jersey, the **coalition, the planning process, the Assembly, the buyout, and restoration** are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and a treasured place whose loss is documented, championed by an organised coalition and the Trust, and — where planning fails — bought and rewilded rarely stays developed, as Plémont did not, being saved and returned to nature after fourteen years. The lesson for any Jersey community is to plan for that longer game from the outset: to fight the planning battle in earnest, but to build, in parallel and from the first, the coalition, the Trust relationship, and the public feeling that a buyout will require if planning is lost — so that the community is not starting from nothing at the very moment consent is granted and the fight seems over.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit months — or years — of effort, calibrate honestly, and here that means knowing the win may come not from planning but from a costly buyout, and may take many years. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how open-space and heritage fights tend to go on a small island, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the community can **document the ecological and heritage value**, whether it can **build a credible coalition and the Trust behind it**, whether the **Assembly can be moved to fund a purchase**, and whether a **buyout and restoration** are possible. Where the place is treasured and the coalition strong, the levers here are real, as Plémont shows; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that planning consent may already be granted, that the win may require raising millions, and that it may take a decade or more.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	10–20%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step

How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in a Jersey development fight are the **coalition and the Trust, the planning process, the Assembly, the buyout, and restoration**. Plémont shows the ceiling: a fourteen-year coalition, the Trust, and the Assembly saved a headland even after planning was lost — through a costly buyout. But it also shows the honest limits: the planning fight was lost, the win required millions and a decade and more, and it leaned on public money that was contentious. Most Jersey fights of this kind will sit between a Plémont save and a place built, and the honest lesson is that the coalition, the Assembly, and the buyout are strong levers here — able to save a place even after planning fails — but that the win may be slow, costly, and reliant on a conservation purchase rather than a planning victory.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The coalition and the Trust** — Jersey's foundation for these fights; the organised movement and the conservation body that can hold land, as at Plémont.
2. **The buyout and restoration** — the distinctive lever; acquiring and rewilding a site even one with planning consent.
3. **The Assembly route** — the political path to public funding for a purchase.
4. **The ecology and heritage case** — the value of a scarce, treasured place, documented.
5. **The public and the media** — the island mobilised into a lasting cause.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few patterns recur, at Plémont and in Jersey's open-space fights. **Planning is not the last word** — a site can be saved by buyout even after consent. **The Trust is decisive** — a body that can acquire and hold land turns a campaign into a purchase. **The Assembly can fund a save** — public money, though contentious, can buy a place. **The island will endure** — fourteen years of campaigning is possible on a place people love. **But the win may be slow and costly** — Plémont took a decade and more and over eight million pounds. The through-line: **document the value; build the coalition and the Trust; work the Assembly; pursue the buyout and restoration — because a community that does can save even a place the developers have won the right to build, as islanders saved Plémont, while being honest that the win came by purchase, over fourteen years.**

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective campaign begins by finding the exact project and loss that govern the threat — and the leverage the community holds, which here is often the coalition, the Trust, the Assembly, and the possibility of a buyout. Vague opposition goes nowhere; a fight aimed at "the housing consent granted for this eleven-acre coastal headland of rare species and heritage, which the Trust could buy and rewild if the Assembly helps fund it" is a campaign — the kind that saved Plémont. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. **What treasured place would be lost?** This is the first question here. What **ecological and heritage value** — coast, rare species, landscape, archaeology — would the development destroy, as Plémont's puffins, green lizards, and history held.
2. **Could the site be bought and saved?** Would the **owner sell to a conservation body**, and could the **Trust acquire it**, even with planning consent, as at Plémont.

3. Can the Assembly be moved to help? Could a **proposition win public funds** toward a purchase, as the States funded half of Plémont.

4. What coalition and Trust backing can be built? Which **environmental groups, the National Trust, and the public** will stand together and endure, as they did for fourteen years.

5. Who decides, who owns, and who is with us? Which planning authority and developer are involved, who owns the land, and which groups and public will stand with the community.

A Worked Example

Suppose a coastal headland has planning consent for housing, and the developer intends to build.

Working the five questions: **what treasured place would be lost? Could the site be bought? Can the Assembly help fund it? What coalition and Trust backing can be built?** And the deciders are the planning authority, the owner, and the Assembly, with the coalition, the Trust, the Assembly, and the buyout as the pressure points.

Within a season you have moved from "consent is granted and nothing can be done" to a plan: document the value; build the coalition and the Trust; pursue a buyout; and win Assembly funding. That is a campaign, not a complaint — and it is exactly how Plémont was saved, even after planning was lost.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, where a buyout must be justified and the Assembly persuaded to spend public money, the ecological, heritage, and value evidence is decisive. A planning inspector, the Assembly, the Trust, the public, and a journalist all move on evidence, not indignation — and in a Jersey open-space fight, a clear record of what would be lost and why the place is worth buying is precisely what a campaign turns into a save, so build it well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Project, the Consent, and the Deciders

Get the facts the case turns on. Identify the **project, its developer, the land it would take, the planning applications and any consent granted** — as Plémont's consent for twenty-eight homes was — and establish **who owns the site and whether they would sell**. Establish the deciders and the ownership precisely, because a granted consent shifts the fight from planning to purchase, and knowing whether the owner will sell is the key to a buyout. Pay particular attention to the owner's intentions and circumstances, because in a buyout fight the owner is not only an adversary but a potential seller. An owner holding a permission they are slow to build, facing the cost and difficulty of developing a contested coastal site, may prove more willing to sell to a conservation buyer than a bare planning dispute would suggest.

Understanding that possibility early, and cultivating the conditions for a sale, is often as important as any objection.

Layer 2: The Value — Ecology and Heritage

Document what would be lost, and here the **ecological and heritage value is central**. Establish, with the National Trust, naturalists, and heritage experts, the place's **rare species, habitats, landscape, and archaeology** — the puffins, the green lizards, the Dartford warblers, the newts, the historic and wartime remains that made Plémont exceptional. Photographs, species records, and expert and heritage assessments make the value vivid and credible, and justify both the case against development and the case

for spending to buy the site. On a small island where coast and open space are scarce and loved, this evidence is the single most powerful thing this file can contain.

Layer 3: The Loss, the Buyout, the Funding, and the Leverage

Finally, document the case. Does the **ecological and heritage value** show a place worth saving? Is a **buyout feasible** — a willing seller, a price, the Trust's capacity? Could the **Assembly be persuaded to fund** part of it, and could **fundraising** cover the rest? And where is the **leverage** — the coalition, the public, the Trust, sympathetic legislators? Each is a separate element, and together they make a case that can save a place even after planning is lost — as they saved Plémont. This is the layer that most often decides these fights, because here a treasured place, a feasible buyout, a funding path, and an organised public are joined — exactly the case that bought and rewilded Plémont. Build it well, and the value, the buyout, and the coalition become the community's strength. One practical note on building this layer: because the Jersey win so often turns on a purchase, the feasibility of the buyout must be documented with the same rigour as the ecology. It is not enough to wish the site bought; the campaign must establish, as concretely as it can, that the owner would sell, at roughly what price, and how that price might be met — what the Assembly might reasonably be asked to vote, and what fundraising might realistically raise. A buyout case built on hope collapses when the numbers are demanded; one built on a willing seller, a defensible valuation, and a credible funding plan can carry an Assembly and a fundraising drive. At Plémont the eventual figure — over eight million pounds, half from the States — was large, but it was concrete and defensible, which is why it could be raised. Do that work early, consulting those who know land and value, because a documented, feasible buyout is what turns a community's wish into a deal.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists. Here is where the material tends to live in a Jersey open-space fight, and how to get it — with the **ecological and heritage value**, the **buyout feasibility**, and the **planning and Assembly handles** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Project and Consent Record

Start with the project itself. **Planning applications, inquiry reports, and any consent granted** are matters of record and show what is intended and where it stands, as Plémont's long application history and 2012 consent did. **Ownership records** establish who holds the land and whether a sale is possible. Establish exactly **what the project is, who owns and backs it, and whether consent is granted**, because a granted consent turns the fight toward a buyout, and a willing seller is the key to one.

The Ecological and Heritage Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather, with the **National Trust for Jersey, naturalists, and heritage experts**, the evidence of the place's **rare species, habitats, landscape, and archaeology** — the protected wildlife, the coast, the historic and wartime remains, as Plémont's puffins, green lizards, warblers, and Occupation-era fortifications held. Photographs, species records, and expert assessments make the value vivid and credible. On a small island where the coast is treasured, Photographs, species records, and expert assessments make the value vivid and credible, and give the Trust, the Assembly, and the public alike a concrete sense of what is at stake. On a small island where the coast is treasured, this evidence both argues against development and justifies the cost of a buyout. It is worth documenting not only the rare species and the beauty but the place's meaning to islanders — the generations who have walked it, the

memories attached to it, the role it plays in the island's sense of itself — because in a fight that will ask the public to fund a purchase, the emotional and cultural value of a place is as persuasive as any species list, and often more so.

The Buyout and Funding Evidence

Document the path to a purchase, because in Jersey the buyout is often the win. Establish whether the **owner would sell**, at what **price**, and whether the **Trust can acquire and hold** the site; and map the **funding** — what the Assembly might vote, what fundraising might raise — as Plémont's £7.15 million came half from the States and the rest from the Trust's fundraising. A community that can show a willing seller, a workable price, and a funding path turns opposition into a deal, so document the buyout as carefully as the loss.

The Planning and Political Handles

Identify the levers the process provides. The **planning system** allows objection and, sometimes, refusal or challenge — though at Plémont it granted consent, which is why the fight moved on. The **States Assembly** can adopt a **proposition to fund a purchase**, as it did for Plémont after a member lodged one. The **conservation and heritage provisions** weigh in decisions. Map which apply — the objection routes, the Assembly process — because in Jersey, when planning fails, the political route to a funded buyout is often the path to the win.

The People and the Allies

Finally, map the human terrain. Who is affected or connected — the parish, the coast's users, the naturalists? Who are the **groups** already organising, as the National Trust for Jersey was? Who are the **sympathetic legislators, the heritage and wildlife experts, the press**? A Jersey open-space fight is won by a community joined to the Trust and to sympathetic legislators — so map your coalition, especially the Trust and your allies in the Assembly, as deliberately as your evidence. A word on the two allies that most distinguish a Jersey fight, because they are what make the buyout possible. The National Trust for Jersey is not merely a supportive group but a body that can own and hold land in perpetuity, negotiate a purchase, and steward a site for good — the indispensable vehicle of a buyout, as it was at Plémont. And sympathetic legislators in the States Assembly are the ones who can lodge the proposition that unlocks public funding, as Senator Bailhache's did for Plémont. Cultivate both deliberately and early: bring the Trust a credible cause it can commit to, and give legislators the public backing and the sound case they need to champion the spending. Without the Trust there is no buyer; without the Assembly there may be no funding. Together, they are the machinery by which a Jersey community turns a lost planning fight into a saved and rewilded place.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Evidence does not move deciders by itself. A community — organised into a coalition around the Trust, informed, and willing to campaign for years — is what turns the value and the buyout into a save the developers' consent cannot prevent. Plémont proved a close-knit island will campaign for fourteen years; the task is to organise that endurance into a coalition and a purchase.

Why the Community Is Decisive

A planning consent can defeat an objection; an organised coalition, the Trust, and a mobilised public can still save a place by buying it. The community supplies what a campaign runs on: the coalition's credibility, the

Trust's capacity to hold land, the public support that moves the Assembly, the fundraising, and the legitimacy that makes a case an island cause. When a community stands together — as islanders did at Plémont, for fourteen years — even a granted development can be overtaken by a purchase. **A united community is not the backdrop to the campaign; it is the campaign's engine, and its endurance.** That last word matters more in Jersey than in most places, because the distinctive Jersey win is slow. Where a referendum or a court ruling can turn a fight in a season, a buyout can take a decade: a seller must be brought to terms, a price agreed, an Assembly persuaded to vote public money, and hundreds of thousands or millions raised from a small population. A campaign built for a sprint will collapse long before such a fight is won. The Plémont campaign endured fourteen years not by heroic intensity but by patient, sustainable organisation — a coalition that renewed itself, a Trust that held the long-term aim steady, and a public reminded, year after year, of what was at stake. Build for endurance from the first day: pace the volunteers, institutionalise the aim in the Trust, and treat the long timeline not as a burden to survive but as the very medium in which a Jersey save is made.

Finding the Affected Community

Begin with those the project touches most — the **parish, the neighbours, the walkers and naturalists** who know the place — as Plémont's coast was loved across the island. Widen to everyone on a small island who treasures its scarce coast and countryside, which is nearly everyone. Name the shared stake — **our coast, our wildlife, our island, for everyone and forever** — because that is what turns scattered residents into a movement, and a movement into a coalition that can endure and buy a place. The framing matters especially where land is scarce and the win is a purchase. On a small island, every acre of coast lost to housing is gone for good, and Jersey people feel that acutely; the open coast that remains is a dwindling inheritance. But a buyout also asks the island to spend — public money and private donations — to keep a place wild, and that ask succeeds only when the place is framed as belonging to everyone, forever, rather than as one group's preference. Cast the fight as a stand for the whole island's coast, its wildlife found nowhere else, and the inheritance of its children, and you make both the campaign and the fundraising a shared island project rather than a niche cause. That larger frame is both truer and stronger, and it is what made islanders willing not only to campaign for Plémont but to help pay for it.

Coalition-Building Around the Trust

A community allied is stronger than a community alone, and in Jersey the coalition forms around the National Trust. Reach deliberately to the **National Trust for Jersey**, the body that can acquire and hold land and led the Plémont win; **naturalists and heritage experts; environmental groups; sympathetic legislators** who can lodge a proposition; and the **wider public** who will donate and endure. Breadth signals that this is not a fringe objection but a shared defence of the island's coast, and it is the coalition around the Trust, more than any single voice, that a Jersey save is built on.

Sustaining Momentum Across Years

Jersey campaigns can run for many years — Plémont ran from 2001 to a 2015 restoration. Sustain the community with **transparency, small wins, and shared purpose**. Mark each step — a coalition formed, an inquiry engaged, a proposition lodged, funds raised, a purchase agreed, a demolition begun. Because the fight may run for over a decade and end in a buyout, keep the coalition and the Trust's membership warm and the public engaged across the years, and keep the fundraising alive. And carry the work past the save: a restored place, once bought, must be managed and cared for. The community that lasts is the one that stays informed, sees its wins, and keeps its eyes on the place it is working to buy, save, and rewild. This last point deserves emphasis, because a place saved by buyout is not a place finished. Plémont, bought and

cleared, then had to be restored — contamination tested, asbestos removed, wildlife relocated, buildings demolished, the land rewilded and managed for the rare species it shelters. A community that disbands at the moment of purchase leaves that work undone and the restoration at risk. The discipline, therefore, is to carry the campaign into stewardship: to keep enough of the coalition and the Trust's membership engaged to see the restoration through, to help fund and volunteer for the management the site will always need, and to defend the rewilded place against future pressures. The purchase is the turning point, not the finish line; the guardianship of a restored headland is the campaign's true and continuing end.

STEP 4: LEGAL, PLANNING & ACQUISITION CHALLENGES — THE PLANNING PROCESS, THE ASSEMBLY, AND THE TRUST BUYOUT

This is where a Jersey open-space fight is often decided — not only in planning, which may be lost, but through the **States Assembly and a conservation buyout**, backed where needed by legal challenge. Used well, these are among the most powerful levers a Jersey community has, even after planning consent is granted, as the Plémont fight showed.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth, and here it is central. These levers are **real but not automatic, and the win may come by purchase rather than by planning**. Planning consent may be **already granted**, as Plémont's was; a **buyout depends on a willing seller, a price, and funding**; and it may take **years and millions**. A planning objection or legal challenge can **delay or refuse** a development, but the durable Plémont win came not from the planning process but from the **Assembly's funding and the Trust's purchase**. Enter this front clear-eyed: the planning process, the Assembly, and the buyout are the distinctive Jersey levers, strongest when the **place is treasured, a seller is willing, and the public is mobilised** — but the win may be a costly purchase, over many years, rather than a planning victory.

The Planning Process

The first front is planning. The **planning authorities, the minister, and the inquiry process** grant or refuse consent, and are where a community objects, submits evidence, and, where grounds exist, challenges. Press the ecological, heritage, and landscape case through them, because a refusal saves a place outright and cheaply. But be honest, as Plémont was: planning can be lost, and a consent granted after years of applications and an inquiry. If planning fails, the fight is not over — it moves to the Assembly and the buyout.

The Assembly Route

The second and distinctive front is political. The **States Assembly** can adopt a **proposition to fund the purchase of a site**, as it voted roughly half of Plémont's £7.15 million after a senator lodged one. This is the route by which a community, having lost planning, wins public backing to buy a place instead. Cultivate **sympathetic legislators** who will lodge and champion a proposition; make the public case that moves the Assembly; and be ready for the honest contention that spending public money on a buyout provokes. The Assembly route is how a Jersey save is funded, and it is a lever few other places offer so directly.

The Trust Buyout and Restoration

The third and decisive front is the buyout itself. The **National Trust for Jersey** can **acquire, hold, and restore** a site, and it was the Trust's purchase and rewilding that saved Plémont for good. Work with the Trust to **negotiate a purchase** from a willing seller, **raise the funds** through the Assembly and public fundraising, and **restore** the site to nature once bought. This front is expensive and slow, and this guide will

not pretend otherwise — Plémont cost over eight million pounds and took years to clear and rewild. Understand, too, that the restoration is a real project in its own right, not a mere afterthought to the purchase. At Plémont the cleared site had to be tested for contamination, stripped of asbestos, its wildlife relocated, its buildings demolished and their materials recycled, and the land carefully rewilded and then managed for the rare species it shelters — work that itself won conservation awards and continues still. A community planning a buyout should budget and organise for this restoration from the start, because a site bought but left derelict is a save only half made. The purchase removes the threat; the restoration delivers the promise — a place genuinely returned to nature and opened to all — and it is the second half of the work that turns a bought site into a living headland. But it is the lever that saves a place even after planning is lost, and the acquisition and restoration are the real endgame of a Jersey open-space fight. It is worth being precise about why the buyout is so distinctively powerful here, because understanding it changes how a campaign is built. In most planning fights, once consent is granted the community has lost; the developer holds a valuable legal right and can build. The buyout works around that finality: it does not challenge the owner's right to build but purchases the land, and the right with it, converting a legal defeat into a conservation win by treating the site as something to be bought rather than fought over. The genius of the Plémont outcome was exactly this — the community did not overturn the consent for twenty-eight homes; it made the consent moot by buying the land. A community that grasps this stops seeing a granted permission as the end and starts seeing it as a change of instrument, from the planning objection to the purchase. That shift in thinking is often the difference between a campaign that gives up when consent is granted and one that, like Plémont's, goes on to win.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same file of ecology, heritage, and buyout feasibility becomes different arguments for a planning inspector, a legislator, the Trust, a journalist, and the public. Translate deliberately.

For the Planning Authorities

The planning bodies respond to **the rules and the evidence**. Frame the place's value in planning terms: the coast, the rare species, the landscape and heritage the development would harm, and the criteria it fails. Give them the ecological and heritage evidence and press for refusal, because a refusal saves the place cheaply. Make it easy to protect: *here is the value, here is the harm, here is why consent should be refused*. Give the planning authorities, too, the cover of a strong public record, because a decision-maker inclined to refuse a coastal development finds it far easier to do so when a documented, credible community case stands behind the decision. Even where consent is ultimately granted, that record is not wasted: it becomes the foundation of the buyout case, the evidence that persuades the Trust to commit and the Assembly to fund. And if consent is nonetheless granted, be ready to move to the Assembly and the buyout.

For the States Assembly

The Assembly responds to **public feeling, island heritage, and a workable case for spending**. Frame the choice as Plémont's was framed: a chance to save a treasured coastal headland forever, for the island and its future, through a purchase the States can be proud to fund. Give the legislators the public support, the treasured place, and a costed, feasible buyout, so voting the funds becomes a defensible, even celebrated, decision. Acknowledge the cost honestly, and make the case that some places are worth it.

For the National Trust

The Trust responds to **a credible cause and a feasible acquisition**. Give it sound evidence, a willing seller, a fundable price, and public backing, so it can take on the purchase and restoration with confidence. The Trust's capacity is the lever only if the campaign brings it a workable deal, so build the ecology, heritage, and buyout case strong enough for the Trust to commit to, as it committed to Plémont.

For the Media and the Public

The press and the public respond to **beauty, loss, and clarity**. Translate the file into a story anyone can grasp: a beautiful coastal headland, its puffins and wild lizards, cleared for houses — and an island that campaigned for fourteen years and bought it back for nature. The beauty, the scarce coast, the long fight, the happy ending — these make a Jersey story, as they made Plémont's. Keep it accurate; a close-knit island values credibility and remembers overreach.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate. Your credibility is your greatest asset, and on a small island it is quickly tested and long remembered. State the acreage, the species, the price, and the funding precisely, distinguish estimate from established fact, and be honest — including that the win may come by costly buyout rather than planning, and may take years. This honesty extends, importantly, to the question of public money, because a buyout funded by the States rightly invites scrutiny and honest debate. A campaign that airbrushes the cost, or dismisses those who question spending millions of public money on a headland, forfeits the credibility on which the Assembly vote depends. Far better to acknowledge the cost openly, engage the fair objection that the money has other claims on it, and make the positive case that some places are worth buying for the island forever. The Plémont funding was genuinely contentious, debated hard in the Assembly, and the campaign prevailed not by hiding the price but by convincing enough people that the headland was worth it. Be honest about the cost, respectful of those who weigh it differently, and confident in the case that a treasured coast, once bought, is bought for every generation to come. A community that is precise and honest, especially about the value and the cost, is far harder to dismiss than one that overreaches.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and public attention convert your evidence into the pressure the deciders feel, and here the story — a beautiful headland cleared for houses, and an island that bought it back for nature — is one a small island responds to.

Why Media Matters

A planning authority weighing a decision, an Assembly weighing public money, and a public weighing whether to donate all respond to a well-told story. Media does three things here: it **informs and mobilises the public**, it **raises the political cost** of losing a treasured place and the political case for funding a buyout, and it **frames the choice** as heritage and nature against houses. At Plémont, coverage of the beautiful headland and the fourteen-year campaign helped move both the public and the Assembly toward the purchase. A fight kept public, on a small island, is a fight the whole community follows.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the place and the loss. The strongest frame is concrete and warm: *a beautiful coastal headland — its puffins, its wild lizards, its history — cleared for houses, and an island determined to buy it back and return it to nature*. Put the place and the people first, let the ecology and the buyout follow, and invoke the

island's scarce, shared coast. Keep it accurate; overstating the harm or hiding the cost hands the other side its rebuttal. The Jersey story is powerful because the place is genuinely treasured and the buyout genuinely saved it.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience. **Local press and radio** for the whole island; **the Trust's and environmental groups' channels** for the engaged base and the fundraising; **social media** for speed and donations; **naturalists and respected figures** for credibility; and, where a place is of wider significance, **regional and heritage media**. Because Jersey's fight turns on a close-knit public's feeling for its coast and its willingness to fund a buyout, the channels that reach and move that public are the ones that matter most.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate and fair, especially on the ecology, the price, and the funding, and toward the developer and the Assembly — the goal is a credible public case and a fundable buyout, not exaggeration. Protect the community; keep private individuals out of the glare unless they choose it. And sustain it: a Jersey fight can run for over a decade and end in a purchase, so pace the story — a coalition formed, a proposition lodged, funds raised, a demolition begun, a headland reopened — to keep the island engaged across a long campaign, and past the save into the care of the restored place.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real project, the real ecological and heritage detail, and the real buyout figures, keep it factual, and never overstate. Here precision on the value and the cost matters more than force.

8A: Requesting Information from the Planning Authorities

Subject: Request for information — [project], planning and ownership

Dear [official],

I am writing on behalf of [community/group] regarding [project] at [location]. To participate meaningfully in the decisions affecting this coastal site, we request: the **planning applications and any consent granted**; the **environmental and heritage assessments**; the **land and habitat affected**; and information on **site ownership**. Please advise how to obtain these and how to object.

We would be grateful for a response by [date].

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8B: Letter to the National Trust Proposing a Buyout

Subject: Saving [place] — a possible acquisition

Dear [Trust],

Our community is working to save [place], a treasured coastal [headland/green space] of [ecological/heritage value], from [development]. Planning [may be/has been] granted, so we hope to explore a **conservation buyout**, as the Trust achieved at Plémont. We understand the owner [may be willing/should be approached] to sell. Might the Trust consider acquiring and restoring the site, with our support in

campaigning and fundraising? We can provide our documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8C: Letter to a States Member (Proposition)

Subject: Public funding to save [place]

Dear [Member],

We write regarding [place], a treasured coastal site cleared for [development]. We ask you to consider **lodging or supporting a proposition** for the States to help fund its purchase and return to nature, as the Assembly did for Plémont. The place holds [ecological/heritage value], the island treasures it, and a buyout would preserve it forever. We would welcome the chance to brief you.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8D: Letter to an Environmental or Heritage Group

Subject: Join the campaign to save [place]

Dear [group],

We are [group], working to save [place] from [development] and, if planning fails, to buy and restore it. Your expertise and voice would strengthen the coalition, and the island's coast is a stake we all share. May we discuss how we might work together, as the coalition did at Plémont, toward a buyout and restoration?

In solidarity,

[Name, community, contact]

8E: Media Pitch

Subject: A beautiful headland cleared for houses — can we buy it back?

Dear [journalist],

At [location], [place] — [a beautiful coastal headland of puffins and wild lizards] — is cleared for [housing]. Our community is campaigning to buy it and return it to nature, as islanders did at Plémont. There is a clear story here — the beauty, the loss, the island's determination — and we can provide the ecology, the heritage, the buyout plan, and voices.

May we send a briefing?

Sincerely,

[Name, community, contact]

8F: Fundraising Appeal

Subject: Help us buy [place] back for nature

Dear friends,

[Place] — [a treasured coastal headland] — is cleared for [development]. But we have a chance to save it forever, as islanders saved Plémont: by buying it and returning it to nature. We need your help to raise [amount] toward the purchase and restoration. Please give what you can, and share this appeal, so that this beautiful place can be the island's, for everyone and forever.

With gratitude,

[Name, campaign, contact]

8G: Letter to a Naturalist or Expert

Subject: Request for expertise — ecology of [place]

Dear [name],

Our community is working to save [place] from [development] and buy it for nature. Your assessment of its **rare species, habitats, and heritage value** would give our case the credibility it needs — for the planning objection, the Assembly, and the buyout — as naturalists' knowledge did at Plémont. Might you assess the site, or point us to the records?

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8H: Rallying the Community

Subject: Our coast — let us save it together

Dear neighbours,

[Place] — [a treasured jewel of our island's coast] — is cleared for [development]. But we can save it, as islanders saved Plémont, by standing together, campaigning, funding a buyout, and returning it to nature. Please join us: come to [meeting], donate to [fund], and add your voice. Together, over however long it takes, we can buy back what is ours and keep it wild, for everyone and forever.

With determination,

[Name, community group]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes a project is moving fast — consent near, works imminent — and you cannot run the full campaign. Triage to the levers that move fastest, and here that means the coalition, the Trust, and the political route.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what the project is, what treasured place it would take, who owns it, and where planning stands**. Identify the immediate pressure point — a **planning decision, an inquiry, a works date** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **National Trust for Jersey and any sympathetic legislator** at once, because the Trust's capacity and a legislator's proposition are the fastest routes to weight, as they were at Plémont.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **A stark ecology-and-loss fact** — the puffins, the rare lizards, the beauty — can shift a debate in days. **A planning objection** files immediately into the process. **An approach to the Trust** opens the buyout path at once. **A sympathetic legislator's proposition** puts a purchase on the Assembly's table. **A media story** of a threatened headland travels fast. These outpace the slower work of the buyout and restoration, though those may follow. The reason this order works is that a stark, credible fact about a beloved place does two things at once: it gives the public and the press something concrete to rally around immediately, and it signals to the Trust and to legislators that a campaign is serious enough to be worth their commitment. On a small island, a single vivid image — the puffins, the derelict eyesore that could be wild coast again — can move public feeling within days, and public feeling is what ultimately opens both the Assembly's purse and the donors' pockets. That swift mobilisation is what buys the time for the slow machinery of the buyout to engage, and it costs almost nothing but speed and credibility.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a broad coalition overnight, but you can activate a fast one. Reach immediately to the **National Trust for Jersey, environmental and heritage groups, sympathetic legislators**, and any **naturalist** who can speak to the value. A handful of credible voices raising the loss and the possibility of a buyout at the right moment — before consent or works — can buy the time the fuller campaign needs. Speed favours the prepared: know your value, your seller, and your allies before the deadline. And if you are caught genuinely flat-footed, with consent granted and works near, concentrate everything on the two fastest levers: a stark, credible statement of the treasured place's value and imminent loss, aimed at the public and the press; and an immediate approach to the National Trust and a sympathetic legislator to open the buyout and the Assembly routes. Those two, deployed quickly, can generate the public feeling and the political opening that buy time — for a proposition, for a negotiation, for the fuller campaign. Do not try to assemble the whole buyout in a week; raise the alarm credibly and open the Trust and Assembly doors, win a pause or a standstill, and then build toward the purchase. A delay secured is the ground on which the slow work of a buyout is done. And a delay is often more achievable than it seems, because an owner holding a contested coastal permission may have little to lose by pausing, and a planning authority faced with a mobilised public and a possible buyout may welcome breathing room; even a committed developer will frequently accept a standstill rather than force a confrontation over a beloved place, and that standstill is the opening a patient, buyout-minded community needs.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Sometimes you do everything right and still face a wall — not because your case is weak, but because the development is backed and consent is granted. This is Jersey's honest truth for these fights, and Plémont embodied it: after years of applications and an inquiry, consent for houses was granted before the community's final path opened. Name it plainly, because pretending the field is level wastes effort and hope.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific. **Consent is granted**, as Plémont's was. The **owner intends to build** and holds a valuable permission. **Development pressure** — the island's demand for housing and land — favours the project. When planning is lost and the developer is committed, the ordinary levers may be blunted, and you must widen the fight, above all toward the Assembly and the buyout.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field tilts, change the game. Shift weight to the levers that work even after planning is lost: the **buyout**, which can save a site consent has cleared; the **Assembly**, which can fund it; the **Trust**, which can hold and restore it; and the **mobilised public**, whose feeling moves the Assembly and whose donations fund the purchase. Make the treasured place and the feasible buyout so public that funding it becomes the Assembly's defensible choice, and negotiate the purchase from a willing seller. Build the record and the coalition even when planning is lost, because a documented, public, well-funded buyout is how Plémont was saved after the planning battle was over. A tilted field lengthens the odds and changes the tool — from planning to purchase — but it does not end the fight, and Plémont was won on exactly such ground. There is a second reason a tilted field is survivable in Jersey specifically: a granted consent does not compel the owner to build immediately, and a derelict or stalled site can remain in limbo for years, as Plémont's did for over a decade. That limbo, frustrating as it is, is also opportunity: it is time in which a community can build its coalition, cultivate the Assembly, and assemble a buyout, and in which an owner holding an unbuilt permission may become willing to sell rather than develop. A community that keeps its case alive through such a limbo is positioned to seize the moment the owner will deal or the Assembly will fund. Endurance, on a small island where a contested site sits visibly derelict year after year, is not merely patience; it is the strategy of outlasting a stalled development until the purchase becomes possible.

The Honest Possibility of Losing — and of a Costly Win

You may lose, and this guide will not pretend otherwise; you may also win only at great cost and length, as Plémont was won by a multi-million-pound buyout over fourteen years. Both truths belong here. If you lose, the work is still not wasted: the **value was documented, the coalition and the Trust built, the public mobilised, the record made, and the next fight — or the next buyout — starts stronger**. And if you win by buyout, be honest that it came by purchase and public money, not by planning victory — though saving a treasured headland forever, whatever the route, is a real and worthy outcome. Fight to win by planning; if planning fails, pursue the buyout; and defend, afterward, the place you bought and rewilded. That is the honest shape of open-space victory in Jersey.

WHEN IT'S NOT CORRUPTION — AND WHY THE OBSTACLE IS USUALLY POLICY

In some countries this section would concern corruption; in Jersey, honestly, that is rarely the obstacle, and it is fair to say so. Jersey is a stable, rule-of-law jurisdiction, and the wall an open-space campaign meets is almost always **genuine development and housing policy, and the rights of a landowner with consent** — not graft. Distinguishing the two matters, because the response differs.

Telling Policy from Wrongdoing

A planning system granting consent, and a landowner exercising a valuable permission, are working within the law, even where you disagree with the outcome. The marks of a policy obstacle are openness and rationale: a transparent planning process, an inquiry, a stated housing need, a lawful consent. Be rigorous and fair: **do not mistake a planning decision you oppose, or an owner's lawful rights, for wrongdoing**, and do not level accusations the evidence does not support — on a small island especially, an unfounded accusation is both wrong and self-defeating. The honest, and usual, situation is a system genuinely balancing development against open space, and the campaign's task is to shift that balance — and, where planning is lost, to buy the place instead.

Responding to a Policy Wall

A policy wall calls not for exposure but for persuasion, a better case, and a buyout. Push the levers the system respects: the **coalition and the Trust**, the **Assembly**, the **feasible purchase**, and the **island's love of its coast**. Make saving the place the choice the Assembly can be proud to fund and the owner content to enable through a sale, as at Plémont. Where a genuine grievance about process arises, raise it lawfully; but expect, and prepare for, a fight of persuasion and a negotiated, funded buyout, not of exposure.

A Note on Safety and Care

Jersey is a stable, orderly jurisdiction, and the risks here are not those of repression — this is a fight waged in planning submissions, propositions, fundraising, and the press, not one of danger. Still, exercise judgment. Keep the campaign **lawful, documented, and collective**. Be fair to the landowner and the Assembly, in a small society where relationships endure. Handle public money honestly in your arguments, since a buyout funded by the States rightly invites scrutiny. And sustain the community for a long fight and, afterward, for the care of the restored place. Care for the people, and for the island's shared civility, is part of winning.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others. Here is how they fit into a single campaign against a destructive development in Jersey.

The Parallel Campaign

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the ecology, heritage, and buyout-feasibility file. **Target identification** aims it at the deciders. **Local opposition** organises the coalition around the Trust and mobilises the public. **Legal, planning, and acquisition** work presses the planning process, the Assembly, and the buyout. **Media** makes it an island cause. The value and the buyout feed all five at once — a documented headland and a feasible purchase are evidence, a media story, a reason to donate, and the basis of an Assembly proposition together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall. The compounding is the whole point, and in a buyout fight it is especially so, because the purchase depends on everything else. Consider how a single strong fact — the rare species at the threatened place, or the willingness of the owner to sell — travels across all five fronts at once: it is, in the same season, evidence for a planning objection, a headline for the press, a reason for the Trust to commit, an argument for an Assembly proposition, and a spur to fundraising. The buyout in particular cannot be run in isolation; it needs the public feeling to move the Assembly, the Assembly's money and the fundraising to meet the price, and the Trust's capacity to hold the land — all at once. A community running these separately will find the purchase forever out of reach; one running them together, as Plémont's did, assembles the seller, the money, and the buyer into a single deal. The campaign is not a relay but a chorus, and the value of the place and the feasibility of the purchase are the notes it holds.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the project, the value, the ownership, and the deciders; find or build the coalition around the Trust; begin the documentation and the planning objection. **Middle (months and years):** build the coalition and the public case; press the planning process; if it fails, pursue the buyout — negotiate the sale, lodge the Assembly proposition, raise the funds. **Later (years):** complete the purchase, demolish, and restore — the Plémont fight ran from 2001 to a 2015 restoration. A Jersey fight can be a marathon of over a decade, and the care of a restored place has no end; pace the campaign for both. A

practical way to pace it is to organise the campaign around its decision points rather than the calendar: the planning determinations and any inquiry, the moments when the owner might sell, the Assembly's consideration of a proposition, the fundraising milestones, and the phases of demolition and restoration. Plan the visible pushes — the media, the public events, the fundraising appeals — for these moments, when they land hardest, and use the quieter stretches to build the case, cultivate the Trust and the Assembly, and prepare the next step. A campaign that strains continuously across a decade will exhaust itself; one that builds quietly and acts at the decision points conserves the endurance a Jersey buyout demands, and keeps something in reserve for the long stewardship that follows the purchase.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that wins these fights: **document the value; build the coalition and the Trust; work the planning process and, if it fails, the Assembly and the buyout; mobilise the public — and keep every claim precise and honest.** The community that presses all five, grounded in a treasured place and a feasible purchase, joined to the Trust and the Assembly, and prepared for a long and costly fight, is the one that saves even a place the developers have won the right to build — as islanders saved Plémont, buying a headland cleared for houses and returning it to nature.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Stopping a destructive development in Jersey is genuinely possible, and the Plémont fight shows both how — and, honestly, how the win may come by a costly buyout over many years rather than a planning victory. The task is not to find a single silver bullet but to press every lever together: the coalition and the Trust, the planning process, the Assembly, the buyout, and restoration.

Some honest truths hold across every campaign here. **The coalition and the Trust are the foundation, and the buyout is the distinctive weapon. The Assembly can fund a save, and a close-knit island can be mobilised and can endure. But planning may be lost, the win may require millions and a decade, and public money spent on a buyout is contentious, as Plémont's was.** Hold both truths at once: real power, real qualifications.

Above all, keep the discipline that gives these fights their strength. Build the ecology and heritage file. Build the coalition around the Trust. Work the planning process, and if it fails, the Assembly and the buyout. Mobilise the public and raise the funds. And be honest — including about the odds, about the win coming by purchase, and about the cost and the years — because a precise, honest community defending a treasured headland, and ready to buy it if planning fails, is far harder to defeat than a project hoping the community gives up once consent is granted.

Plémont was cleared for houses, consent granted after years of applications and an inquiry, an eyesore of derelict buildings on one of the island's finest coasts. And still islanders saved it — campaigning for fourteen years, winning the Assembly to fund half the purchase, raising the rest, buying the headland, demolishing the buildings, and returning the land to nature and to the public. It was a buyout, not a planning win; it cost millions and took a decade and more; this guide has said so plainly. But the houses were never built, the puffins keep their neighbour, the puffins keep their quiet neighbour, and the headland is the island's, forever and for everyone. The tools that saved it are real, the Trust, the Assembly, and the buyout the strongest among them, and they are available to any community willing to organise and endure. Your island's coast and heritage are worth defending, and worth buying back if it comes to that; Your island's coast and heritage are worth defending, and worth the years of patience, the coalition-building, and the fundraising a buyout demands, and worth buying back if it comes to that; the odds are better than "consent is granted and nothing

can be done"; the odds are better than "consent is granted and nothing can be done," as fourteen years of islanders proved by buying a headland back from the very edge of development; and the fight — waged the way Plémont was — is one worth waging. Islanders won it. So can you. Hold onto the specifics of how they did it, because they are the whole lesson: they did not surrender when planning was granted; they turned from objection to purchase; they built the coalition and the Trust and the Assembly support that a buyout requires; and they endured for fourteen years until the headland was theirs. Those are choices any community can make. Make them, work through the coalition and the Trust and the Assembly, pursue the buyout when planning fails, and steward the place once it is rewilded, and you give your island's coast its best chance in a system that, for all that a granted consent can seem final, still lets a determined and patient island buy a treasured place back and return it to nature. And they did it not with power of the kind the developer held, but with organisation, endurance, a body that could hold land, and an island's willingness to pay to keep a place wild — the tools this system offers any community prepared to use them. They documented the headland's value, built a coalition around the National Trust, campaigned for fourteen years, won the Assembly to fund half the purchase, raised the rest, and bought and rewilded the site. None of that required defeating the developer's rights; it required the patience to pursue a buyout and the credibility to fund it. Bring those, work through the coalition and the Trust and the Assembly, pursue the purchase when planning fails, and defend the place once it is bought, and you give your island's coast its best chance. The odds are better than surrender, and a treasured place that an island is determined to buy back is a hard thing for any developer to hold against it forever.